



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

God's Creation, Science & Faith Study Workbook

Exploring Origins, Wonder, and Big Questions Without Fear - For Ages 13-19

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class



HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Teens are often told they must pick faith or science. This six-unit study refuses that false choice. Explore what the Bible says about creation, the Fall, restoration, and worship - and work through honest questions about origins, suffering, and science with confidence, not fear. For ages 13 to 19.

PSALM 19:1

"The heavens declare the glory of God."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

What's Inside

- 1 How to Use This Study
- 2 Table of Contents
- 3 **Unit 1: The God Who Creates**
- 4 **Unit 2: Made in His Image**
- 5 **Unit 3: When Creation Broke**
- 6 **Unit 4: The Promise of Restoration**
- 7 **Unit 5: Faith and Science Together**
- 8 **Unit 6: Worshiping the Creator**
- 9 Memory Verse Review
- 10 Spiritual Check-In
- 11 Final Reflection
- 12 Study Notes

UNIT 1

The God Who Creates

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1

Unit Overview

This unit explores the Bible's claim that a personal God created all things with purpose - and why that changes how we see the universe and ourselves.

DEVOTIONAL

A Universe With an Author

The first four words of the Bible make a staggering claim: reality has an Author, not just an origin.

GENESIS 1:1

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth."

If the universe is authored, it has meaning and direction. If it's an accident, meaning is something we invent.

Genesis doesn't read like a science lab report; it reads like a declaration that everything belongs to God.

Reflect

1. Does it matter to you whether the universe has an Author? Why?

2. How would believing creation is purposeful change how you see your life?

PRAYER PROMPT

Creator God, help me see your world as authored and meaningful, not accidental.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Creation Speaks

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 19:1-4

"The heavens declare the glory of God; the skies proclaim the work of his hands. Day after day they pour forth speech; night after night they reveal knowledge. They have no speech, they use no words; no sound is heard from them. Yet their voice goes out into all the earth, their words to the ends of the world."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What do the heavens 'declare'?

2. How do they 'speak' without words?

3. How far does their message reach?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Creation Speaks

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How can creation communicate something true about God?

2. What can nature tell us - and not tell us - about God?

Application - What will I do?

1. When has nature made you sense something bigger than yourself?

2. How could you 'listen' to creation this week?

WORD STUDY

Creator

MEANING

The one who brings all things into being. God is distinct from creation, not part of it.

Where It Appears

COLOSSIANS 1:16

"For in him all things were created: things in heaven and on earth."

REVELATION 4:11

"You are worthy... for you created all things."

Dig Deeper

1. Why does it matter that God is separate from creation, not the universe itself?

2. How does being a creature (not the Creator) give you both humility and worth?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Wonder

What part of the natural world amazes you most?

How does it point you toward or away from God?

Write a short prayer of wonder to the Creator.

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Doesn't the Big Bang Replace God?

THE QUESTION

If science explains how the universe began, is God unnecessary?

Think It Through**How vs. Why**

Science can describe mechanisms; it can't explain why there's something rather than nothing.

A beginning invites a cause

A universe with a beginning raises the question of what caused it.

Not competitors

Describing how God may have done something doesn't remove God any more than knowing how an engine works removes the engineer.

Your Response

1. Have you felt science and faith must conflict? Where did that idea come from?

2. What question about origins do you most want to explore?

UNIT 2

Made in His Image

"So God created mankind in his own image." - Genesis 1:27

Unit Overview

Of all creation, humans are unique - image-bearers with dignity, purpose, and responsibility. This unit explores what that means for identity and ethics.

DEVOTIONAL

The Crown of Creation

In a vast universe, the Bible makes a bold claim: human beings uniquely bear God's image.

GENESIS 1:27

"So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them; male and female he created them."

Being an image-bearer means every person has dignity that no accomplishment adds and no failure removes.

It also means we're responsible - image-bearers are meant to reflect God's care into the world.

Reflect

1. How does being an image-bearer affect your sense of worth?

2. How should it change how you treat people you dislike or disagree with?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me see your image in myself and in every person.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Given a Job

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 2:15

"The Lord God took the man and put him in the Garden of Eden to work it and take care of it."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did God give the man to do?

2. Was work part of the world before or after sin?

3. What two verbs describe his task?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Given a Job

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does it mean that work existed before the Fall?

2. How does 'take care of it' shape how we treat creation?

Application - What will I do?

1. How do you view work - as a curse or a calling?

2. How could you 'take care of' your corner of the world?

WORD STUDY

Stewardship

MEANING

Responsible care of what belongs to another. Humans are stewards, not owners, of creation.

Where It Appears**PSALM 24:1**

"The earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

"It is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful."

Dig Deeper

1. If the earth is 'the Lord's,' how should that shape how we live?

2. What has God entrusted to you to steward well?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Dignity and Duty

Where do you struggle to believe you have worth?

Where do you fail to see others' worth?

What responsibility might God be giving you to steward?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

The image of God has huge implications. Discuss them.

1. How does 'image of God' challenge how our culture ranks people?

2. How should Christians think about caring for the environment?

3. How can this group treat each other as image-bearers?

UNIT 3

When Creation Broke

"Cursed is the ground because of you." - Genesis 3:17

Unit Overview

The world is beautiful but broken. This unit faces the Fall - how sin fractured creation - and why that explains the world we actually experience.

DEVOTIONAL

Beauty and Brokenness

Creation is stunning and also groaning. Both are true, and the Bible explains why.

ROMANS 8:20-21

"The creation was subjected to frustration... in hope that the creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay."

The same world that shows sunsets also shows disease and disaster. The Bible traces this tension to the Fall.

But notice the word 'hope': the brokenness is real but temporary. Creation is waiting to be set free.

Reflect

1. Where do you most feel the world's brokenness?

2. How does 'hope' of restoration help you hold that honestly?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me grieve what's broken while trusting your promise to restore it.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Creation Groans

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ROMANS 8:22-25

"We know that the whole creation has been groaning as in the pains of childbirth right up to the present time. Not only so, but we ourselves... groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for our adoption to sonship, the redemption of our bodies. For in this hope we were saved."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is creation compared to?

2. Who else groans?

3. What are we waiting for?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Creation Groans

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why 'pains of childbirth' rather than just decay?

2. How does hope change the way we experience suffering?

Application - What will I do?

1. What are you 'groaning' about right now?

2. How does future hope reshape present pain?

WORD STUDY

The Fall

MEANING

The event and ongoing reality of humanity's rebellion against God, which fractured creation and relationships.

Where It Appears

ROMANS 5:12

"Sin entered the world through one man, and death through sin."

1 JOHN 5:19

"The whole world is under the control of the evil one."

Dig Deeper

1. How does the Fall explain the mix of good and evil you see?

2. Why is it more honest than saying the world is either all good or all bad?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Honest About Brokenness


Where do you see brokenness in the world?


Where do you see it in yourself?


What hope do you need to hold onto?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Why Natural Disasters and Disease?

THE QUESTION

If God made a good world, why is nature sometimes deadly?

Think It Through**A world affected by the Fall**

The Bible describes creation itself as subject to frustration and decay.

Not the final state

Scripture promises a restored creation without death or pain.

God enters the suffering

The Christian hope isn't a God distant from pain but one who redeems it.

Your Response

1. How do you personally wrestle with natural suffering?

2. What would you say to a friend angry at God over a disaster?

UNIT 4

The Promise of Restoration

"Behold, I am making all things new." - Revelation 21:5

Unit Overview

The story doesn't end in brokenness. This unit explores the biblical hope of a renewed creation and how it shapes how we live now.

DEVOTIONAL

All Things New

The Bible doesn't end with escape to a distant heaven; it ends with heaven and earth renewed.

REVELATION 21:4

"He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the old order of things has passed away."

God's plan isn't to trash creation but to restore it. The future is physical, good, and whole.

This hope isn't escapism; it fuels people to work for good now as a preview of what's coming.

Reflect

1. How does the hope of restoration change how you view death and loss?

2. How might it motivate you to do good now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you that you are making all things new. Give me that hope.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A New Creation

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

REVELATION 21:1-4

"Then I saw 'a new heaven and a new earth,' for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away... I heard a loud voice from the throne saying, 'Look! God's dwelling place is now among the people, and he will dwell with them...' He will wipe every tear from their eyes. There will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does John see?

2. Where is God's dwelling place now?

3. What will be no more?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A New Creation

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does it matter that God dwells with people, not far away?

2. How is this different from popular ideas of the afterlife?

Application - What will I do?

1. What tears do you long to have wiped away?

2. How does this future shape today?

WORD STUDY

Restoration

MEANING

God's renewal of all creation, healing what sin broke and making everything new.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 8:21**

"The creation itself will be liberated from its bondage to decay."

ACTS 3:21

"He must remain in heaven until the time comes for God to restore everything."

Dig Deeper

1. How is restoration different from destruction or escape?

2. What in your life do you most long to see restored?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Living in Hope

What future promise gives you the most hope?

How can that hope change how you live now?

Write a prayer of hope for restoration.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

The end of the story reshapes the middle. Discuss.

1. How does hope for the future affect how we treat the present world?

2. How is Christian hope different from wishful thinking?

3. How can this group live as people of hope?

UNIT 5

Faith and Science Together

"Great are the works of the Lord; they are pondered by all who delight in them." -
Psalm 111:2

Unit Overview

Many teens are told they must choose faith or science. This unit shows how they can work together and how to handle honest questions.

DEVOTIONAL

Two Books

Christians have long spoken of two 'books' from God: Scripture and nature. Both are worth studying.

PSALM 111:2

"Great are the works of the Lord; they are pondered by all who delight in them."

Studying how the world works can be an act of worship, not a threat to faith. Many great scientists were believers.

You don't have to fear questions. A faith that can't be questioned is a faith that can't grow.

Reflect

1. Have you felt you had to choose between faith and science? Where did that come from?

2. How might studying science actually deepen your worship?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me love truth wherever I find it and never fear honest questions.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Wisdom and Understanding

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PROVERBS 25:2

"It is the glory of God to conceal a matter; to search out a matter is the glory of kings."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is God's glory in this verse?

2. What is the 'glory of kings'?

3. What does this say about investigating the world?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Wisdom and Understanding

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How does this verse dignify curiosity and investigation?

2. Why might God 'conceal' things for us to discover?

Application - What will I do?

1. What are you curious about that you've been afraid to explore?

2. How can curiosity be part of your faith?

WORD STUDY

Wisdom

MEANING

Skill in living well according to God's truth; the right use of knowledge, including knowledge of the world.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 9:10**

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom."

JAMES 1:5

"If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God."

Dig Deeper

1. How is wisdom more than just information?

2. Where do you need to ask God for wisdom right now?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Questions About Faith and Science

What science-and-faith questions do you have?

Who could help you explore them well?

What would it look like to hold faith and honest inquiry together?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Investigate Well

Faith welcomes honest investigation. Practice it.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Write down your biggest faith-and-science question.
- ☐ Ask a knowledgeable Christian adult about it.
- ☐ Read one thoughtful resource on the topic.
- ☐ Thank God for the wonder of the natural world this week.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Worshiping the Creator

"You are worthy... for you created all things." - Revelation 4:11

Unit Overview

The right response to creation isn't just information but worship. This unit turns the study into praise and a way of life.

DEVOTIONAL

From Study to Worship

The point of studying creation isn't to win arguments; it's to know and worship the Creator.

ROMANS 1:20

"For since the creation of the world God's invisible qualities... have been clearly seen, being understood from what has been made."

Creation is a signpost. If you stop at the sign and never follow it to God, you've missed the point.

Worship is the natural response of a creature who realizes how good and great the Creator is.

Reflect

1. Do you tend to stop at the 'signpost' or follow it to God?

2. How could your daily life become more worshipful?

PRAYER PROMPT

Creator God, let everything I learn lead me to worship you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Worthy of Worship

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

REVELATION 4:11

"You are worthy, our Lord and God, to receive glory and honor and power, for you created all things, and by your will they were created and have their being."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is God worthy to receive?

2. Why is he worthy?

3. By whose will do all things exist?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Worthy of Worship

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is being Creator a reason for worship?

2. What does it mean that things exist 'by his will'?

Application - What will I do?

1. What would it look like to give God 'glory, honor, and power' this week?

2. Where do you withhold worship?

WORD STUDY

Worship

MEANING

Ascribing worth to God - with our words, choices, and whole lives, not just music.

Where It Appears

ROMANS 12:1

"Offer your bodies as a living sacrifice... this is your true and proper worship."

PSALM 96:9

"Worship the Lord in the splendor of his holiness."

Dig Deeper

1. How is worship more than singing?

2. How can ordinary life - study, work, rest - become worship?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

A Life of Worship

What has this study taught you about the Creator?

How will you respond with worship, not just knowledge?

Write a prayer of praise to the Creator.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. Study should end in worship.

1. How has studying creation affected your view of God?

2. How can your whole life be worship, not just church?

3. How can this group encourage a lifestyle of worship?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

GENESIS 1:1

"Genesis 1:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:1

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:27

Write out from memory: Romans 8:22

Write out from memory: Revelation 21:5

Write out from memory: Psalm 19:1

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

How has this study changed how you see the world?

How will you respond to the Creator?

Write a prayer of worship to the God who made all things.

NOTES

Study Notes

NOTES

Study Notes